

UBS after Credit Suisse: What Enterprise Architecture Can Learn from Integration at Scale

UBS has a habit of collecting unusual assets. It had a large art collection even before 2023, and after acquiring Credit Suisse, it also inherited a client base, [art and estate](#), people, data and applications, as well as a fair amount of operational headache. The point is not the art collection. The point is that Credit Suisse became part of UBS's collection of assets, obligations and complexity.

To be fair, it was not a normal, voluntary acquisition. UBS was effectively “*made an offer it could not refuse*”. Still, the transaction gave UBS a distressed global bank with [CHF 1.29tn](#) of assets under management in Credit Suisse's [last full-year report](#) before the deal. UBS did not just acquire an old brand. It acquired client assets, data, people, platforms and a competitor.

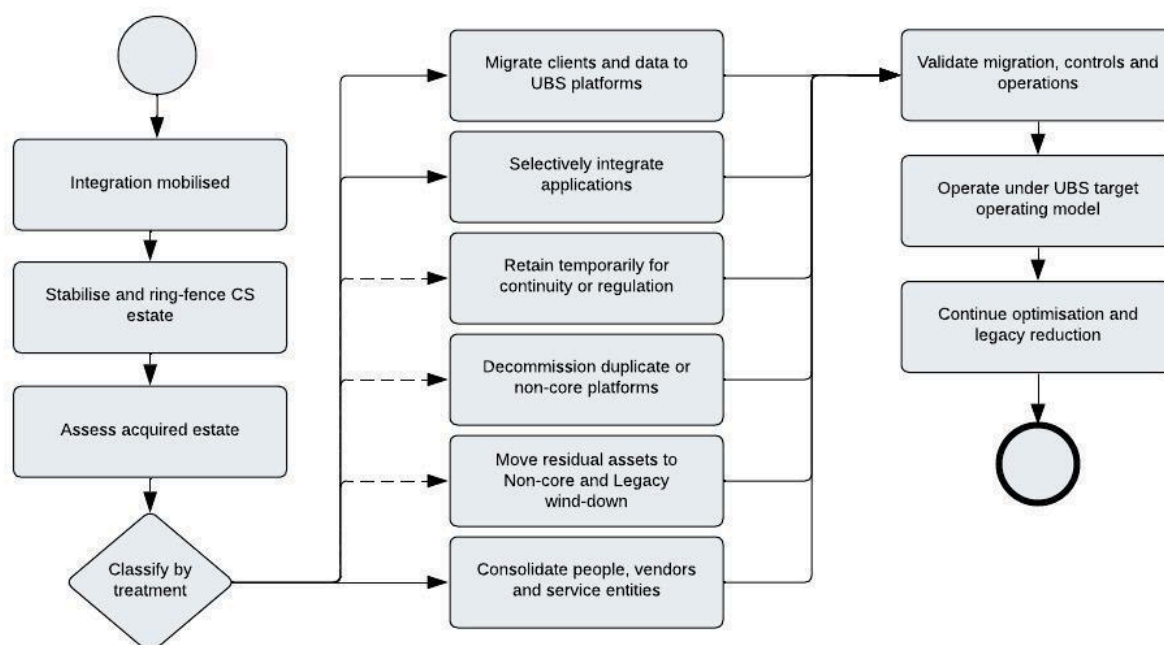
Nevertheless, we are now witnessing one of the biggest integrations in banking history, and that drives my interest in how this integration affected enterprise architecture (EA).

Considering the sheer scale of the entities and the short integration timeframe, the interesting question is not whether UBS deserves applause but whether simultaneous change in both technology and business architecture is practically **possible**. This is also why [Sergio Ermotti's](#) return to UBS matters in this story. Public reporting positioned his return around the need to steer a transition where financial, regulatory, operational and architectural decisions had to move together.

My working hypothesis is simple: it may be possible to remove duplicate technology **faster** than duplicate business capability. UBS may retire applications, platforms and infrastructure, but that does not automatically prove it has removed the underlying operating functions, controls, data obligations or capability duplication. That distinction is what makes the Credit Suisse integration useful as an EA case.

1. Integration process

If we speculate on what the high-level integration process looked like, it should be something similar to the diagram below. The process diagram answers a fundamental question: what **treatment paths** were available once UBS inherited the Credit Suisse estate? It helps show the sequence and, more importantly, the number of parallel treatment paths.



Credit Suisse to UBS: Integration Process and EA Treatment Model

Figure 1. Simplified process view based on public information and selected examples. The diagrams in this article are analytical, not official.

The process is not just "absorb Credit Suisse into UBS". That would be too simple. A more realistic process is: stabilise the acquired estate, assess applications, data, processes, controls, people and legal entities, then classify each part of the estate by treatment.

At the process level, the crucial point is **classification**. One part of the estate can move to UBS platforms. Another part may need temporary retention because of continuity, regulation, archive or wind-down needs. Some assets and processes can be retired. Support and shared services need their own consolidation path.

That distinction matters. Post-merger EA is not only about drawing the future-state box. It is about deciding which treatment is appropriate for each domain, and then proving that the chosen treatment works.

That is why I would avoid turning the process into a simple application migration plan. The useful language is treatment: migrate, integrate, rationalise, retain, decommission. Each verb has different owners, data risks, controls and exit criteria.

2. Impact on architecture

Now, if we look at the shift from Credit Suisse EA to UBS EA, there were several business and technical transformations: migration of clients and accounts, migration of products, migration of data, integration of selected applications, decommissioning of redundant or non-core platforms, and retention of some capabilities where regulation or business continuity required it. In the short term, UBS likely inherited a larger and more complex transition-state architecture, even if the target direction was simplification.

Before looking at the diagram, it helps to separate capability treatment from application treatment. UBS was not only deciding which systems to keep. It also had to decide what happened to inherited capabilities.

Potential treatment scenarios:

- Same capability [UBS has a target model] > migrate
- Strategic capability in both banks > integrate > standardise
- Duplicated support capability > consolidate
- Useful Credit Suisse capability > selectively integrate
- Required but not strategic > retain > rationalise
- Not needed in the target model > wind down or retire

This is the core distinction: public evidence can show application and infrastructure reduction, but it does not fully prove capability simplification.

With that treatment logic in mind, the next diagram shows how Credit Suisse capabilities and platforms could be routed toward a UBS target-state architecture without treating both estates as equal long-term platforms.

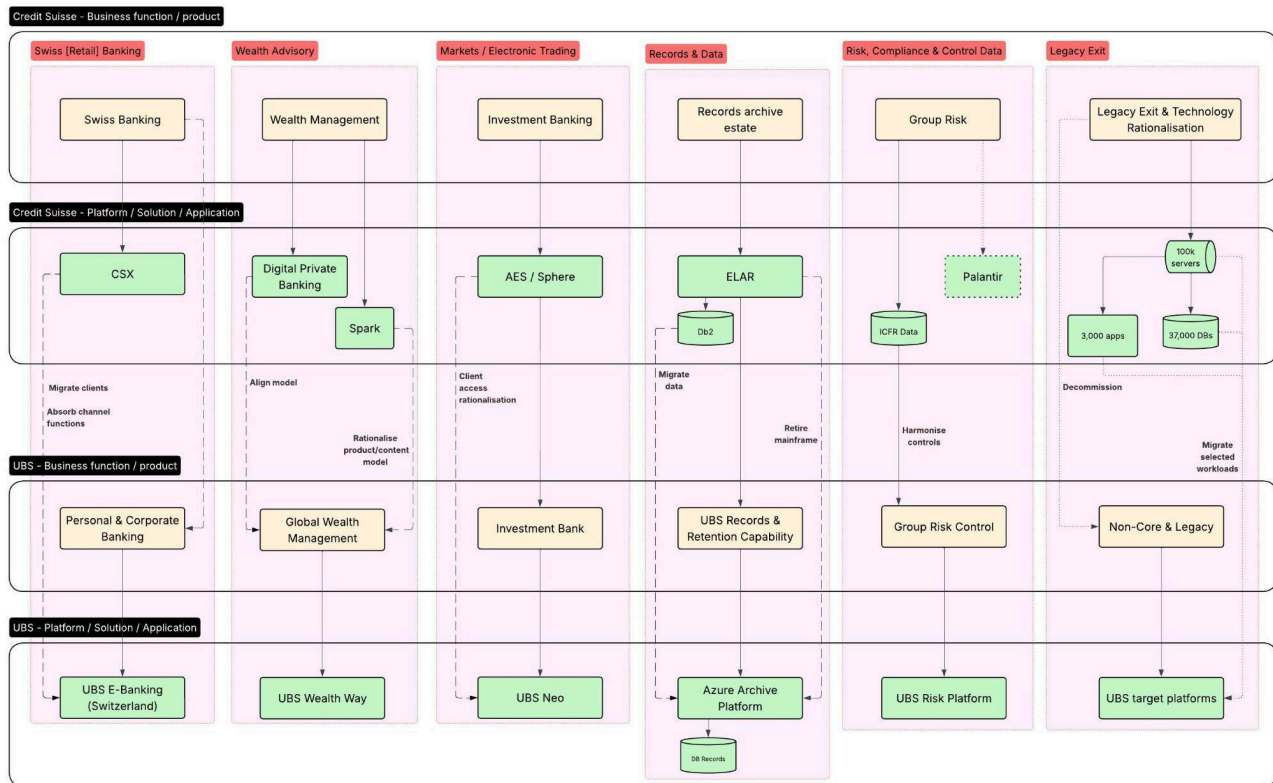


Figure 2. Simplified enterprise architecture treatment view based on public information and selected examples.

Read this as a treatment map rather than a claim of neat one-for-one equivalence. The examples below show why the same integration can include migration, decommissioning and temporary retention at the same time.

The strongest example is client and account migration. UBS reported in [Q1 2026](#) that it had **completed** client account migrations following the transfer of all Swiss-booked clients onto UBS platforms. This is a simple sentence with a lot hidden inside it. Client migration means data mapping, account migration, product mapping, access, statements, controls, testing, operational readiness, and client communication. It is not just a system switch.

Another important example is decommissioning. UBS's [Q2 2025](#) media release said it had decommissioned **1,154** applications, around 40% of the total in scope, turned off more than half of in-scope servers, around 60,000, and worked through **28PB** of data. These are useful numbers because they show that UBS did not simply put a UBS wrapper around the Credit Suisse estate. It removed a material part of the inherited technology footprint.

But here is the caveat. Retiring applications and servers is not the same as removing business capability duplication. A retired application may be small. A retained application may be critical. A duplicated business capability may survive as a manual process, a retained control, a regional exception, a legacy data store, or a non-core wind-down activity. This is where EA needs to be careful and not confuse technology reduction with capability simplification.

The pre-acquisition Credit Suisse estate also matters. Credit Suisse's [2022 annual report](#) described varied and complex data-processing systems and disclosed material weaknesses in internal control over financial reporting. [The Stack reported](#) a fragmented estate of more than 100,000 servers,

90,000 workstations, 37,000 relational databases, around 3,000 applications and 13 data centres. That is not a small estate waiting politely to be absorbed. It is a transition-state architecture with its own risks, controls, and unfinished simplification agenda.

There is one very concrete example of inherited plumbing. A [Microsoft customer story](#) says UBS migrated ELAR, the largest records-management system of ex-Credit Suisse, from Mainframe Db2 in a Swiss data centre to Azure. It says ELAR held nearly 2PB of data, 50,000 tables and 200bn records. I would not use this to claim that all Credit Suisse core banking was mainframe-based. That would be too broad. But it is a good reminder that integration is also about records, legal hold, retention, identity, auditability and old data that cannot simply be deleted because the slide deck says "target state".

3. Operating model

Finally, UBS had to revisit its operating and support model for the new estate. This is one of the most painful parts of the whole quest, because it involves people.

However painful it was, the acquisition created a reason to revisit the support model. You know how it is, "*if it works, don't touch it*", until the organisation has no choice but to "touch" it.

Both Credit Suisse and UBS had their own support models, shaped over the years by business needs, technology choices, controls, locations and vendor arrangements. This is where the role of technology and operations leadership becomes important. During much of the integration period, Mike Dargan's technology and operations remit sat close to the practical problem: how to keep the combined estate running while applications, infrastructure, data and support ownership were being rationalised.

Clearly, maintaining two models makes no strategic and financial sense. At the same time, a new, bigger and more complex estate could not simply be supported by one model unchanged. The support model diagram below should help answer the operating model question: how does support move from the inherited model toward a UBS-led model?

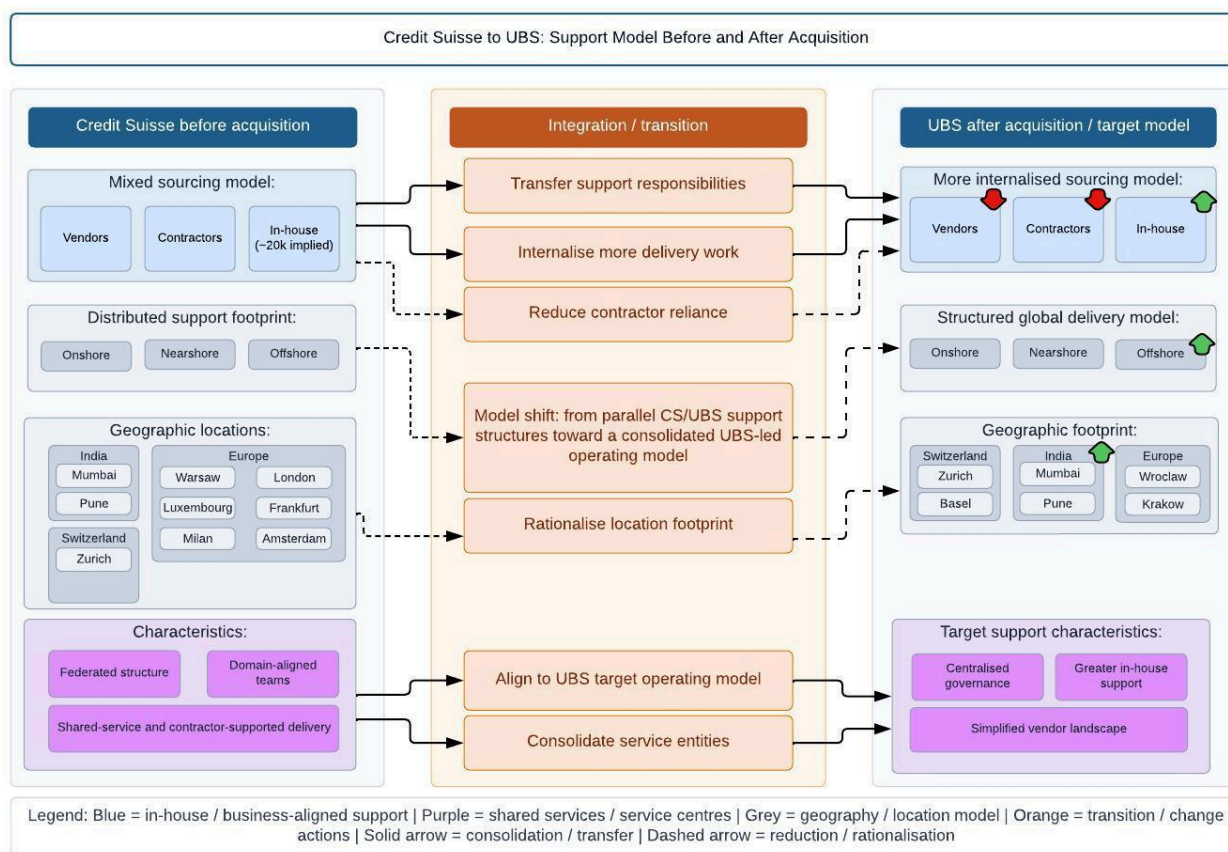


Figure 3. Simplified support-model view based on public information and selected examples.

Public evidence supports a move toward a more consolidated support model. The clearest example is India. UBS announced in [April 2025](#) that Credit Suisse service-company entities in India had been merged into UBS Business Solutions India. The release says this brought together a **24,000**-strong team across Mumbai and Pune, covering technology, operations, HR, finance, legal, compliance, risk and procurement.

That is not just a location note. It is an operating-model signal. Shared services, support ownership, control accountability, workforce data, access, tooling, vendor dependency and service management all sit behind that change. If platforms are consolidated but support remains fragmented, the architecture is only half integrated.

Public evidence does not prove that every process, tool, control and service catalogue was harmonised. A legal or organisational merger can happen before the operating model is genuinely simple. It is safer to say that UBS moved toward a more consolidated, UBS-led support model, with **India** as a major combined delivery hub, rather than claiming that the support model was fully simplified, because public evidence does not prove that.

There is also the legal-entity angle. [Public reporting](#) said Credit Suisse AG ceased to exist as a separate entity and UBS succeeded to its rights and obligations. This sounds administrative, but from an EA perspective, it is important. Legal entity architecture affects booking models, client contracts, reporting, capital, tax, data ownership and platform migration. Sometimes, you cannot move the system until the legal wrapper allows the move.

One final step of the CS merge plan is workforce reduction. Public reporting pointed to [roughly 3,000 staff reductions in Switzerland](#) and wider estimates of [30,000 to 35,000 possible reductions globally](#). Hard decision, but an inevitable consequence of a merger at this scale. From an operating model perspective, workforce reduction is not just a cost action. It is also a signal that duplicated roles, locations, governance layers and support structures are being rationalised.

4. Architecture lessons from the UBS-Credit Suisse integration

First, treat inherited capabilities differently. The acquisition did not simply add Credit Suisse to the UBS estate. It forced UBS to classify the acquired estate: migrate, integrate, retain, decommission, or wind down.

Second, make the target architecture explicit. UBS appears to have used its own platforms and operating model as the target, rather than preserving a permanent two-bank architecture. That does not mean every **duplicate** capability disappeared. It means the integration direction was clear.

Third, do not confuse technology reduction with capability reduction. Public evidence shows that many applications and servers were retired. The harder question is whether end-to-end business capabilities have become **simpler**. That is much harder to prove from the outside.

Fourth, operating-model integration matters as much as platform integration. Shared-service consolidation, support ownership, control accountability and India as a major combined delivery hub show that integration is not only about applications.

Fifth, legal-entity architecture can dictate migration **sequencing**. Client contracts, booking models, reporting, tax, capital, data ownership and regulatory obligations can decide when a system, process or data store is actually movable.

Sixth, the [MIT CISR operating-model](#) direction looks like **Coordination** moving toward selective **Unification**. UBS still has different business domains, markets and regulatory treatments. But client migration, shared-service consolidation, legal-entity simplification and application decommissioning all point toward more common foundations.

So my conclusion is slightly different from the original hypothesis. It may be **possible** to remove duplicate technology faster than I expected. But removing duplicate business capabilities is harder, and public evidence does not prove that UBS has fully done that.

In other words, UBS, after Credit Suisse, is a useful EA case because it shows the difference between absorbing a company and absorbing its complexity. The first is a transaction. The second is an architectural challenge.

Selected public sources

[UBS to acquire Credit Suisse — CHF 3bn deal and acquisition terms](#)

[Credit Suisse 2022 Annual Report — pre-acquisition baseline](#)

[The Stack — Credit Suisse pre-acquisition technology estate reporting](#)

[UBS Q1 2026 media release — Swiss-booked client migration to UBS platforms](#)

[UBS Q2 2025 media release — application, server and data decommissioning](#)

[UBS India service-company integration](#)

[MarketWatch legal-entity summary](#)

